

Concerning Spiritual Gifts

A study in 1 Corinthians 12

1 Corinthians 12:1 — “Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.”

Concerning spiritual gifts, I should not be ignorant, I should not be misinformed, and I should not be lackadaisical.

1. What They Are, and Who Gives Them

Spiritual gifts are a **supernatural, divine and spiritual endowment**.

- **The Giver** is God the Holy Spirit (1 Corinthians 12:4, 8, 11).
- **The receivers** are believers, the people who have the indwelling of the Spirit (1 Corinthians 12:2–3).

It is important to know that **the indwelling comes before the gifts**. There are diversities of gifts, but one Giver, the same Spirit.

2. Why Are There Diversities of Gifts? — 1 Corinthians 12:12

There are diversities of gifts, and all of them are given by the self-same Spirit. But there are no diversities of gifts for one person to be the custodian. We do not have diversities of gifts for the sake of one person.

- It is not necessary for one person to have all the gifts, and it is not for one person to monopolise the gifts of the Spirit.
 - There are gifts to go round, gifts for every member of the church, to the end that the Church is **not lacking in any gift**.
 - There should not be any member of the church who says the gifts are not for them.
 - Our spiritual gifts are meant to **complement one another**, because they come from the same source.
 - **No believer is exempted** from manifesting the gifts of the Spirit. And you do not need a platform to manifest some of them.
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3. Do Not Demean Your Gift — 1 Corinthians 12:15–16

Some people will always be in front, like the eyes. But the ear must not say, “*Because I am not the eye, I am not part of the body.*”

We do not demean our spiritual gifts.

4. Do Not Exalt Your Gift — 1 Corinthians 12:21

The eye cannot say to the hand, *“I have no need of you.”*

There is no chance for boasting, even with spiritual gifts. The end of the manifestation of spiritual gifts is that **God is glorified** (2 Corinthians 12:9–10).

5. Unity and Love in the Exercise of the Gifts

Unity should be maintained in the Church even with the expression of the diversities of gifts. There are diverse gifts, but those who carry them should not see themselves as set against each other.

All of the spiritual gifts should be **administered in love**. There is something it is compulsory for us to walk in, and that is love (1 Corinthians 13).

Knowing God’s character as portrayed in Scripture is the baseline for recognising His leadings through other means. **You cannot effectively minister the things of the Spirit if you do not understand the Scriptures.**

6. Desire Them Earnestly

The gifts of the Spirit should be an object of our desire and our pursuit. It should be something we aim for. We should **covet the gifts earnestly** (1 Corinthians 12:31; 14:1).

“Spiritual gifts should be the object of our desires and pursuits, all in subordination to the grace, the will and the pleasure of God.”

See also Romans 12:6 and 1 Corinthians 12:11, 18 — the Spirit distributes *“to each one individually as He wills,”* and God sets the members in the body *“just as He pleased.”*

The end of our spiritual gifts is that **God is glorified and men are edified** (1 Corinthians 14:26).

7. What Can Be Communicated Through the Gifts of the Spirit

Truths about God. Insight into the person of God, and revelation of God, can be communicated through the gifts of the Spirit.

Truths about individuals. God can reveal things concerning people through the administration of the gifts, whether past, present or future.

All of the gifts of the Spirit do something, and all to the end that the recipients of the manifestation are **edified**.

Examples in Scripture

- **Nathan the prophet** — 2 Samuel 12:1–15. He had a message to deliver to David, and it led the king to serious repentance.
 - **Agabus** — Acts 11:27–28 and Acts 21:10–11. Known in the New Testament as a prophet; he foretold the famine, and later Paul’s binding at Jerusalem.
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Closing

The gifts of the Spirit are very important to every believer.

May God help us, that we would receive the gifts, and that we would be a blessing to others.

End of lesson notes.